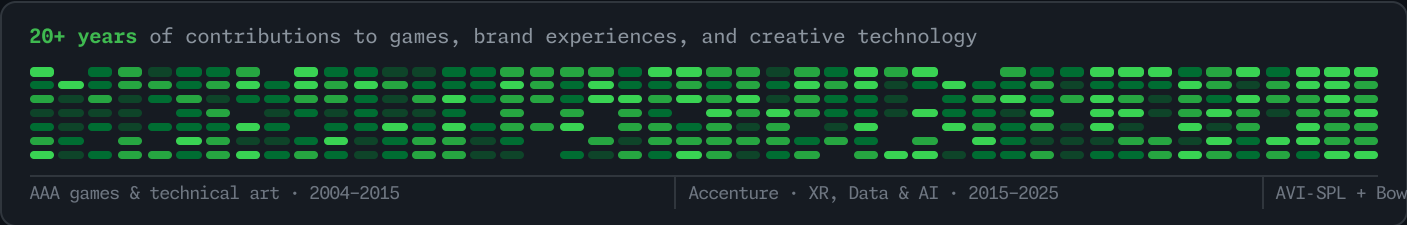


Joshua Opel

Creative Director · Brand systems, developer-authentic storytelling, AI-assisted production

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Profile

README.md

Creative leader with 20+ years building high-performing teams, scalable brand and design systems, and interactive experiences across gaming, enterprise technology, XR, and AI. I lead senior creative talent **without over-directing it**: translating executive priorities, product narratives, and business signals into clear creative direction, then creating the conditions for the team to do its best work.

Developer culture is not adjacent to my career; it is my career. I shipped AAA titles, taught game artists, built creative tooling used by global teams, and now run an AI-native studio where every prototype lives in a repo. I know what developer-authentic looks like because I have been the audience for two decades.

Experience

git log --graph

Practice Director, Real-Time Design AVI-SPL

2025 - present

Strategic and creative leadership for an enterprise real-time visualization practice across distributed teams

- Set creative direction for enterprise visualization initiatives, translating business objectives into **scalable creative standards, documentation, and enablement** adopted across distributed design and engineering teams
- Present creative strategy and emerging technology to **executive stakeholders and enterprise customers**, and protect team focus by clarifying priorities across sales, engineering, product, and leadership
- Champion responsible AI-assisted workflows that give designers leverage **without sacrificing craft**

Spatial Director, XR Data & AI Accenture

2015 - 2025

Creative leadership across global immersive technology, digital twin, AI visualization, and brand experience programs

- Founded **Gen3D Studio**, an internal generative AI creative capability, scaling it from **6 to 200+ practitioners in under 90 days at 85% adoption** in service of a roughly 700,000-person organization
- Part of the marketing team for the XR and gaming group, building **interactive demos and promotional content for CES and SXSW**, high-visibility brand moments delivered on hard deadlines
- Directed creative vision for enterprise XR and digital twin experiences, producing **executive demonstrations for Fortune 500 clients** that made complex technical systems legible through visual storytelling
- Developed scalable workflows and internal creative tools adopted globally, while mentoring artists, designers, and technical creatives across multidisciplinary teams

Founder & Creative Director Bowler Hat Studio

2024 - present

Independent AI-native studio at the intersection of brand, game development, and creative tooling

- Design and ship AI-assisted creative production tools: Blender extensions, Unity editor tooling, interactive web applications, and rapid concept-to-demo pipelines, **built and iterated in public repos**
- Practice what the studio preaches: AI that augments artists instead of replacing them, with humans owning taste and intent

Earlier Career

git log --merges

↗ Senior Environment / Technical Artist · Certain Affinity & Terminal Reality

Environments, technical art pipelines, and optimization for shipped AAA titles

DOOM (2016)

Team Fortress 2

Ghostbusters

The Walking Dead

Star Wars

↗ Lead Artist · The Cypress Inheritance

Artistic leadership across environment production and visual quality throughout development

↗ Lead Instructor · The DAVE School

Mentored future game artists through complete production pipelines: curriculum, critiques, and industry preparation

Leadership & Innovation

CONTRIBUTING.md

AI Production Tools Initiative

- Built a growing suite of AI-assisted creative tools: Unity production tools, Blender workflow enhancements, interactive planning applications, and rapid prototyping frameworks that **reduce production friction while keeping artists at the center**

Knights of Production · AI Roundtable

- Founded an ongoing community for responsible AI adoption in creative industries, facilitating discussions and demos on human-centered workflows, developer tools, and production innovation

Enterprise XR & Digital Twin Experiences

- Directed creative vision for immersive experiences that communicate complex products, facilities, and technical systems through interactive storytelling

Leadership Highlights

- Led multidisciplinary teams of artists, designers, motion and presentation specialists, developers, and engineers
- Presented creative strategy and emerging technology to executive leadership and Fortune 500 organizations
- Built scalable creative systems that let brands travel consistently across teams, channels, and regions
- Mentored creative talent at every level of a 20+ year career, from students to senior specialists

topics

creative-direction

brand-systems

visual-identity

design-systems

executive-storytelling

motion

presentation-design

creative-ops

people-leadership

stakeholder-mgmt

stack

adobe-cc

figma

blender

unity

unreal

three-js

github

copilot

claude

xr

digital-twins

real-time

patent

Rendering Virtual Objects in 3D Environments

U.S. Patent · 2018

education

The DAVE School

Digital Animation & Interactive Media

philosophy

Create environments where talented people can do their best work. Great creative organizations run on clarity, trust, mentorship, and thoughtful systems, not on a director in every pixel.